

Suren Jamal Mohammed

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Education

Ph.D. Student, Political Science | *University of Florida* **Expected 2027**
GAINESVILLE, FLORIDA, UNITED STATES

Major Field: Comparative Politics; **Minor Field:** Political Methodology
Dissertation: Explaining the Spatial Logic of Communal Violence
Dissertation Committee: Ben Smith (Chair), David Siroky, Michael Bernhard

Graduate Certificate in Digital Geography and GIS | *University of Florida* **Expected 2026**
GAINESVILLE, FLORIDA, UNITED STATES

Master of Arts in Political Science | *University of Florida* **2023 – 2025**
GAINESVILLE, FLORIDA, UNITED STATES

Master of Arts in International Affairs | *Missouri State University* **2021 – 2023**
SPRINGFIELD, MISSOURI, UNITED STATES

Field: Middle East Politics

Bachelor of Arts in International Studies | *American University of Iraq-Sulaimani* **2017 – 2021**
SULAIMANI, KURDISTAN REGION, IRAQ

Major: International Security, **Minor:** Economics

Research Interests

Political Violence; Ethnic Conflict; Self-determination conflicts; Conflict Forecasting; Civilians Targeting; International Security; Middle East Politics; Kurdish Politics

Pee-reviewed Publications

Mohammed, Suren J. & Romano, David (2023). *The Kurdish Conflict in Turkey: The Central Role of Identity Recognition (or Lack Thereof)*. *Ethnopolitics*, 1–18.

Work in Progress

Mirilovic, Nikola; **Mohammed, Suren**; Siroky, David *Great Power Politics and the Timing of Recognition: Evidence from Bangladesh, 1971–74*. Under review.

Mohammed, Suren J *Why Does Communal Violence Vary Locally: Evidence from Iraq (2003–2009)*. Expected Submission: Spring 2026.

Siroky, David; Wang, Yu; **Mohammed, Suren** *Predicting Self-Determination Conflict: A Stage-Specific Framework for Theory Adjudication Using Machine Learning*. Under review.

Mohammed, Suren J & Siroky, David *Detect–Predict: A Prospective Early-Warning System for Political Instability*. Data collection is underway.

Mohammed, Suren J *The Logic of Insurgency Revisited: A Machine Learning Approach to Feasibility vs. Motivation*.

Research & Teaching Experience

Graduate Research Assistant — <i>University of Florida</i>	Fall 2024 – Present
Graduate Teaching Assistant — <i>University of Florida</i>	2023 – 2024
Graduate Research Assistant — <i>Missouri State University</i>	2021–2023

Human Languages

Kurdish(Native); English (Fluent); Arabic (Advanced); Persian (Intermediate)

Computer Languages

Python, R, SQL, ArcGIS Pro, L^AT_EX

Quantitative Statistical Skills & Interests

Data Collection; Causal Inference; Machine Learning; Spatial Analysis; Web Scraping

Fellowship

Predoctoral Fellow — <i>Gainesville, FL, United States</i>	2024 – Present
Violence, Conflict, and Security (ViCS) Lab, University of Florida.	
Peace & Conflict Fellowship — <i>Sulaimani, Iraq</i>	2019
Institute of Regional and International Studies (IRIS) and Global Public Policy Institute (GPPi).	

Training

Quantitative and Qualitative Research Training — <i>Sulaimani, Iraq</i>	2020
UK Arts & Humanities Research Council (AHRC); Institute of Regional & International Studies (IRIS); and Global Public Policy Institute (GPPi).	

Conferences

Northeastern Political Science Association — <i>Boston, United States</i>	2023
Peace Science Society — <i>Orlando, United States</i>	2025

Grants & Awards

Travel Grant-(\$350) — <i>University of Florida, Gainesville, Florida</i>	2023
Awards — <i>Best Graduate Student Paper of the Year</i>	2024-2025

Affiliations

- Member — *Violence, Conflict, and Security Lab*, Florida Institute for National Security (vics.lab.ufl.edu), 2023–Present.